

A True Jew in Heart

We have been working on Romans 2:12-14. In Romans 3:9, Paul says:

"What then? are we better than they?
No, in no wise:
for we have before proved both Jews and Gentiles,
that they are all under sin."

Romans 1 and 2 are Paul's case proving that both Jew and Gentile are under sin.

When God first visited me in my office and showed me the Born-Again Trail, there was a rapport between my spirit and His Spirit. Whatever I communed in my heart, He seemed to answer immediately. I asked about the great verses:

"The works that I do shall he do also;
and greater works than these shall he do."

And:

"Nothing shall be impossible unto you."

Those verses show what is possible to a believer who knows God, yet so few walk close to what they promise. I asked where the real answer was.

He said, "The answer you are looking for is in the verses most people leave out."

We leave them out because truth is line upon line, precept upon precept. It is hard to put a roof on a building before the foundation and walls are up. Many difficult verses require a foundation before they can be understood.

A doctrine that separates you from other believers is often a group of Scriptures where you chose to stop. How far can someone leave "Do not pray in tongues" behind and still keep that doctrine? How far can someone explore the verses about the gifts of the Spirit without truth confronting him?

Even after being baptized in the Holy Spirit, the Holy Spirit must still be our Illuminator and Teacher. We can stop anywhere we want and lock Him up. You can believe exactly what your father and mother believed until the day you die.

One major key I stumbled into was praying in tongues. I do not know whether I found it by accident or not; I only knew I had to survive the hours I had committed to in the prayer closet. Praying in tongues became the form of prayer I used.

It turned out to be a revelation gift. It began opening chapter after chapter and book after book. After many years, enough foundation and walls had been laid for God to drop the Born-Again Trail into my spirit.

The people who often love the Born-Again Trail most are those who have been through many churches and many moves. When they see what is available, they know their walk does not depend on anybody else. Nobody can give it to you, and nobody can take it away.

When you were born again, the whole deposit was made in your new nature. Nobody has the power to stop you: not flesh, not the devil, not another person.

When I looked down that trail under the gift of faith, I knew I could do anything God said. But God said the answers were in verses we commonly leave out because we do not have enough foundation to understand them.

Romans 2 contains one of those verses. Nestled in this chapter is a verse about the judgment seat of Christ.

Romans 2:12-13 says:

"For as many as have sinned without law
shall also perish without law:
and as many as have sinned in the law
shall be judged by the law;
for not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

The problem was that no spiritually dead man could be justified by law, because it was impossible for him to be a doer of it. The part Paul is dealing with is the nature of the Ten Commandments, the moral righteousness no unregenerated man could keep.

Then Paul says:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves."

The Gentile who has no law by commandment can, by the new nature, do the things contained in the law. The Ten Commandments, in their moral nature, are written inside the born-again spirit. Nobody has to preach, "Thou shalt not commit adultery," or "Thou shalt not steal," for the new nature to bear witness.

Romans 2:15-16 says:

"Which shew the work of the law
written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while
accusing or else excusing one another;
in the day when God shall judge
the secrets of men
by Jesus Christ according to my gospel."

That is the standard by which I will be judged. The more I pray in the Holy Ghost, the more my new nature is empowered by Him. The more mysteries of Christ I pray up and understand, the more I can walk by that new conscience.

Anything my new nature accuses, I do not have to excuse. If I could not stop what my new nature accuses, then God would have no right to judge me by that standard.

Power rests on this kind of foundation. God likes to use His power to execute your freedom in who you are in Christ Jesus. He likes you to condemn through that conscience everything that is wrong, to walk in love, and to live unafraid of even those who kill the body.

Jesus said the servant who did not know his lord's will and did not do it would be beaten with few stripes, but the one who knew and did not do it would be beaten with many. He is not talking about punishment in the lake of fire. He is talking about loss of reward.

God makes allowance for ignorance, deception, and limited understanding. The new nature is not your Teacher; it is your moral nature. It gives you a conscience freed from sin and a capacity to understand God. Then the Holy Spirit comes as Teacher.

What makes you accountable is when you say, "I see," and then walk away without caring.

So what do we do? We sell out as though we are already in eternity. We give God His revival and take millions home with us.

Romans 2:1-2 says:

"Therefore thou art inexcusable, O man,
whosoever thou art that judgest:
for wherein thou judgest another,
thou condemnest thyself;
for thou that judgest doest the same things.
But we are sure that the judgment of God
is according to truth
against them which commit such things."

God's judgment is absolutely just and justified. Until I understand that about His nature, there is a place in me that asks, "What about the person on an isolated island who never heard?" If I am going to have stronghold-pulling-down, mountain-moving, revival-producing faith, I must know my Father has dealt justly with every human being in every dispensation.

Faith is based on what God has said. I cannot simply "take by faith" something I do not know from His Word. Knowing His justice gives me confidence that everything I can believe for from His Word, He will do.

Romans 1 lists the fallen condition:

"Being filled with all unrighteousness,
fornication, wickedness, covetousness, maliciousness;
full of envy, murder, debate, deceit, malignity;
whisperers, backbiters, haters of God..."

Paul says they know the judgment of God, that those who commit such things are worthy of death, and not only do them but take pleasure in those who do them.

Then Romans 2 says, "Therefore thou art inexcusable, O man, whosoever thou art that judgest." At first that seems strange, because it looks like those sins deserve judgment. But Paul is speaking to the Jew who judged Gentiles while doing the same things.

The Jew rested in the law and believed the law saved him, yet broke the law. Paul says in Romans 2:17-24 that the Jew boasts in God, knows His will, and teaches others, but then asks:

"Thou therefore which teachest another,
teachest thou not thyself?
thou that preachest a man should not steal,
dost thou steal?"

If the law could save the Jew, why was he doing the same things he condemned in the Gentile?

The Jewish community in Rome struggled with Gentiles entering the same inheritance without keeping the law. Later Judaizers accepted that Gentiles could be saved, but insisted they had to keep the law to be perfected.

That Judaizing spirit nearly overturned the early church. God used Paul powerfully because Paul knew the law deeply. God took him into the backside of the desert and poured grace onto that foundation.

I have wondered why God sent Paul to the Gentiles and Peter to the Jews. Peter had little knowledge of the law compared with Paul. Even years after the resurrection, Peter was still shocked when God poured out the Spirit on Cornelius' household. He said, in effect, "Who was I to withstand God?"

Paul, born out of due season, could stand up to Peter and say, "If you left the law once, why go back to it when certain men from Jerusalem arrive?" Paul understood grace well enough to defend Gentile inheritance.

Romans 2:25 says:

"For circumcision verily profiteth,
if thou keep the law:
but if thou be a breaker of the law,
thy circumcision is made uncircumcision."

If the Jew could not keep the law, circumcision became uncircumcision. But if the Gentile, who did not have the law, receives a new nature and keeps the righteousness of the law, then his uncircumcision is counted as circumcision.

Romans 2:28-29 says:

"For he is not a Jew,
which is one outwardly;
neither is that circumcision,
which is outward in the flesh:
but he is a Jew,
which is one inwardly;
and circumcision is that of the heart,
in the spirit,
and not in the letter."

The true Jew is the one whose old man has been cut away by circumcision of the spirit. That is the inheritor, the seed of Abraham who has inherited the promise.

Romans 3:1 asks:

"What advantage then hath the Jew?
or what profit is there of circumcision?"

Paul answers:

"Much every way:
chiefly, because that unto them
were committed the oracles of God."

God had to separate a nation to serve His altars, sacrifices, and promises pertaining to the Seed, to get Jesus into the earth. He entered covenant with Abraham and protected that bloodline.

That does not mean God ignored others. Job lived around the time of Abraham and said, "I know that my Redeemer liveth." God sent Jonah to Nineveh because He cared about people who could not discern between their right and left hand.

God judges according to truth. Anyone calling on Him found Him responding with the light available to them.

Romans 3:9 says:

"We have before proved both Jews and Gentiles,
that they are all under sin."

Then verse 19 says:

"Now we know that what things soever the law saith,
it saith to them who are under the law:
that every mouth may be stopped,
and all the world may become guilty before God."

God held the standard up before the world. If Israel could not keep the law, neither could the Gentile. Every mouth was stopped, and the whole world became guilty before God.

Romans 3:20 says:

"Therefore by the deeds of the law
there shall no flesh be justified in his sight:
for by the law is the knowledge of sin."

The law unveiled the horrible nature of sin in unregenerated men. It showed why all needed mercy.

When the Gentile, by the new nature, keeps the things contained in the law, he becomes a law unto himself. Paul adds that this is the judgment system for the day we stand in God's presence.

Learn to walk by the dictates of that new nature. Pray in the Holy Ghost so the morality of the Ten Commandments surfaces in strength. Let the new nature accuse or excuse every thought that comes from anywhere.

The answer to power is not merely in verses about exploits. It is in the verses that show what God intends to build under those exploits: a son whose new nature is strong enough to govern his life.